Supplementary Data S1

Appendix 1. PubMed search strategy (N = 86)

#1 "esophageal neoplasms".[Mesh]

#2 "esophageal neoplasm*".ti,ab.

#3 "esophagus neoplasm*".ti,ab.

#4 "oesophageal neoplasm*".ti,ab.

#5 "esophageal cancer*".ti,ab.

#6 "esophagus cancer*".ti,ab.

#7 "oesophageal cancer*".ti,ab.

#8 "cancer of esophagus".ti,ab.

#9 "cancer of the esophagus".ti,ab.

#10 "esophageal tumor*".ti,ab.

#11 "esophagus tumor*".ti,ab.

#12 "oesophageal tumor*".ti,ab.

#13 "esophageal carcinoma*".ti,ab.

#14 "esophagus carcinoma*".ti,ab.

#15 "oesophageal carcinoma*".ti,ab.

#16 #1 OR #2 OR #3 OR #4 OR #5 OR #6 OR #7 OR #8 OR #9 OR #10 OR #11 OR #12 OR #13 OR #14 OR #15

#17 "EGFR inhibitor*".ti,ab.

#18 "epidermal growth factor receptor inhibitor*".ti,ab.

#19 "anti-human epidermal growth factor receptor".ti,ab.

#20 #17 OR #18 OR #19

#21 "cetuximab".[Mesh]

#22 "erbitux".ti,ab.

#23 "IMC C225".ti,ab.

#24 "IMC-C225".ti,ab.

#25 "MAb C225".ti,ab.

#26 "C225".ti,ab.

#27 "C-225".ti,ab.

#28 #21 OR #22 OR #23 OR #24 OR #25 OR #26 OR #27

#29 “panitumumab”.[Mesh]

#30 “ABX-EGF monoclonal antibody”.ti,ab.

#31 “ABX-EGF MAb”.ti,ab.

#32 “vectibix”.ti,ab.

#33 #29 OR #30 OR #31 OR #32

#34 “nimotuzumab”.ti,ab.

#35 “theraloc”.ti,ab.

#36 #34 OR #35

#37 “erlotinib hydrochloride”.[Mesh]

#38 “erlotinib HCl”.ti,ab.

#39 “erlotinib”.ti,ab.

#40 “tarceva”.ti,ab.

#41 “11C-erlotinib”.ti,ab.

#42 “11C erlotinib”.ti,ab.

#43 “OSI-774”.ti,ab.

#44 “OSI 774”.ti,ab.

#45 “OSI774”.ti,ab.

#46 “CP 358774”.ti,ab.

#47 “CP-358774”.ti,ab.

#48 “CP358774”.ti,ab.

#49 #37 OR #38 OR #39 OR #40 OR #41 OR #42 OR #43 OR #44 OR #45 OR #46 OR #47 OR #48

#50 “gefitinib”.[Mesh]

#51 “iressa”.ti,ab.

#52 “ZD1839”.ti,ab.

#53 “ZD-1839”.ti,ab.

#54 #50 OR #51 OR #52 OR #53

#55 #20 OR #28 OR #33 OR #36 OR #49 OR #54

#56 “randomized controlled trials as topic”.[Mesh]

#57 “randomized controlled trial[publication type]”

#58 “random*”.ti,ab.

#59 “clinical trials as topic”.[Mesh]

#60 “clinical trial[publication type]”

#61 “controlled clinical trials as topic”.[Mesh]

#62 “controlled clinical trial[publication type]”

#63 #56 OR #57 OR #58 OR #59 OR #60 OR #61 OR #62

#64 #16 AND #55 AND #63

Appendix 2. EMBASE search strategy (N = 831)

#1 'esophagus tumor'/exp

#2 'esophageal neoplasm*':ab,ti

#3 'esophagus neoplasm*':ab,ti

#4 'oesophageal neoplasm*':ab,ti

#5 'esophageal cancer*':ab,ti

#6 'esophagus cancer*':ab,ti

#7 'oesophageal cancer*':ab,ti

#8 'cancer of esophagus':ab,ti

#9 'cancer of the esophagus':ab,ti

#10 'esophageal tumor*':ab,ti

#11 'esophagus tumor*':ab,ti

#12 'oesophageal tumor*':ab,ti

#13 'esophageal carcinoma*':ab,ti

#14 'esophagus carcinoma*':ab,ti

#15 'oesophageal carcinoma*':ab,ti

#16 #1 OR #2 OR #3 OR #4 OR #5 OR #6 OR #7 OR #8 OR #9 OR #10 OR #11 OR #12 OR #13 OR #14 OR #15

#17 'egfr inhibitor*':ab,ti

#18 'epidermal growth factor receptor inhibitor*':ab,ti

#19 'anti-human epidermal growth factor receptor':ab,ti

#20 #17 OR #18 OR #19

#21 'cetuximab'/exp

#22 'erbitux':ab,ti

#23 'imc c225':ab,ti

#24 'imc-c225':ab,ti

#25 'mab c225':ab,ti

#26 'c225':ab,ti

#27 'c-225':ab,ti

#28 #21 OR #22 OR #23 OR #24 OR #25 OR #26 OR #27

#29 'panitumumab'/exp

#30 'abx-egf monoclonal antibody':ab,ti

#31 'abx-egf mab':ab,ti

#32 'vectibix':ab,ti

#33 #29 OR #30 OR #31 OR #32

#34 'nimotuzumab'/exp

#35 'theraloc':ab,ti

#36 #34 OR #35

#37 'erlotinib'/exp

#38 'erlotinib hcl':ab,ti

#39 'erlotinib':ab,ti

#40 'tarceva':ab,ti

#41 '11c-erlotinib':ab,ti

#42 '11c erlotinib':ab,ti

#43 'osi-774':ab,ti

#44 'osi 774':ab,ti

#45 'osi774':ab,ti

#46 'cp 358774':ab,ti

#47 'cp-358774':ab,ti

#48 'cp358774':ab,ti

#49 #37 OR #38 OR #39 OR #40 OR #41 OR #42 OR #43 OR #44 OR #45 OR #46 OR #47 OR #48

#50 'gefitinib'/exp

#51 'iressa':ab,ti

#52 'zd1839':ab,ti

#53 'zd-1839':ab,ti

#54 #50 OR #51 OR #52 OR #53

#55 #20 OR #28 OR #33 OR #36 OR #49 OR #54

#56 'randomized controlled trial'/exp

#57 'randomized controlled trial (topic)'/exp

#58 'random*':ab,ti

#59 'clinical trial (topic)'/exp

#60 'clinical trial'/exp

#61 'clinical trial*':ab,ti

#62 'controlled clinical trial'/exp

#63 'controlled clinical trial (topic)'/exp

#64 'controlled clinical trial*':ab,ti

#65 #56 OR #57 OR #58 OR #59 OR #60 OR #61 OR #62 OR #63 OR #64

#66 #16 AND #55 AND #65

Appendix 3. CENTRAL search strategy (N = 94)

#1 MeSH descriptor: [esophageal neoplasms] explode all trees

#2 (esophageal neoplasm*):ti,ab,kw OR (esophagus neoplasm*):ti,ab,kw OR (oesophageal neoplasm*):ti,ab,kw OR (esophageal cancer*):ti,ab,kw OR (esophagus cancer*):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#3 (oesophageal cancer*):ti,ab,kw OR (cancer of esophagus):ti,ab,kw OR (cancer of the esophagus):ti,ab,kw OR (esophageal tumor*):ti,ab,kw OR (esophagus tumor*):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#4 (oesophageal tumor*):ti,ab,kw OR (esophageal carcinoma*):ti,ab,kw OR (esophagus carcinoma*):ti,ab,kw OR (oesophageal carcinoma*):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#5 #1 OR #2 OR #3 OR #4

#6 (EGFR inhibitor*):ti,ab,kw OR (epidermal growth factor receptor inhibitor*):ti,ab,kw OR (anti-human epidermal growth factor receptor):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#7 MeSH descriptor: [cetuximab] explode all trees

#8 (erbitux):ti,ab,kw OR (IMC C225):ti,ab,kw OR (IMC-C225):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#9 (MAb C225):ti,ab,kw OR (C225):ti,ab,kw OR (C-225):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#10 #7 OR #8 OR #9

#11 MeSH descriptor: [panitumumab] explode all trees

#12 (ABX-EGF monoclonal antibody):ti,ab,kw OR (ABX-EGF MAb):ti,ab,kw OR (vectibix):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#13 #11 OR #12

#14 (nimotuzumab):ti,ab,kw OR (theraloc):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#15 MeSH descriptor: [erlotinib hydrochloride] explode all trees

#16 (erlotinib HCl):ti,ab,kw OR (erlotinib):ti,ab,kw OR (tarceva):ti,ab,kw OR (11C-erlotinib):ti,ab,kw OR (11C erlotinib):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#17 (OSI-774):ti,ab,kw OR (OSI 774):ti,ab,kw OR (OSI774):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#18 (CP 358774):ti,ab,kw OR (CP-358774):ti,ab,kw OR (CP358774):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#19 #15 OR #16 #17 OR #18

#20 MeSH descriptor: [gefitinib] explode all trees

#21 (iressa):ti,ab,kw OR (ZD1839):ti,ab,kw OR (ZD-1839):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#22 #20 OR #21

#23 #6 OR #10 OR #13 OR #14 OR #19 OR #22

#24 MeSH descriptor: [randomized controlled trials as topic] explode all trees

#25 MeSH descriptor: [randomized controlled trial] explode all trees

#26 (random*):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#27 MeSH descriptor: [clinical trials as topic] explode all trees

#28 MeSH descriptor: [clinical trial] explode all trees

#29 (clinical trial*):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#30 MeSH descriptor: [controlled clinical trial] explode all trees

#31 MeSH descriptor: [controlled clinical trials as topic] explode all trees

#32 (controlled clinical trial*):ti,ab,kw. (Word variations have been searched)

#33 #24 OR #25 OR #26 OR #27 OR #28 OR #29 OR #30 OR #31 OR #32

#34 #5 AND #23 AND #33

Appendix 4. Web of Science search strategy (N = 191)

#1 TS=(esophageal neoplasms OR esophageal neoplasm* OR esophagus neoplasm* OR oesophageal neoplasm* OR esophageal cancer* OR esophagus cancer* OR oesophageal cancer* OR cancer of esophagus OR cancer of the esophagus OR esophageal tumor* OR esophagus tumor* OR oesophageal tumor* OR esophageal carcinoma* OR esophagus carcinoma* OR oesophageal carcinoma*)

#2 TS=(EGFR inhibitor* OR epidermal growth factor receptor inhibitor* OR anti-human epidermal growth factor receptor)

#3 TS=(cetuximab OR erbitux OR IMC C225 OR IMC-C225 OR MAb C225 OR C225 OR C-225) #4 TS=(panitumumab OR ABX-EGF monoclonal antibody OR ABX-EGF MAb OR vectibix)

#5 TS=(nimotuzumab OR theraloc)

#6 TS=(Erlotinib Hydrochloride OR Erlotinib HCl OR Erlotinib OR Tarceva OR 11C-erlotinib OR 11C erlotinib OR OSI-774 OR OSI 774 OR OSI774 OR CP 358774 OR CP-358774 OR CP358774)

#7 TS=(Gefitinib OR Iressa OR ZD1839 OR ZD-1839)

#8 #7 OR #6 OR #5 OR #4 OR #3 OR #2

#9 TS=(randomized controlled trials as topic OR randomized controlled trial OR clinical trials as topic OR clinical trial OR controlled clinical trial OR controlled clinical trials as topic OR random*)

#10 #9 AND #8 AND #1

Appendix 5. ClinicalTrials.gov search strategy (N = 24)

#1 Condition or disease: esophageal neoplasms

#2 Intervention/treatment: cetuximab OR panitumumab OR nimotuzumab OR erlotinib hydrochloride OR gefitinib

#3 Study Results: studies with results

#4 #1 AND #2 AND #3